OPPORTUNITY ATTACK (5E, 2024 RULES) – DESCRIPTION

General rule – Opportunity Attack · "Playing the Game" chapter of SRD 5.2.1

You can make an **Opportunity Attack** when a creature **that you can see leaves your reach** without taking the **Disengage** action and without being teleported or forced to move (which doesn't provoke).

You use your **Reaction** to make **one melee attack** with a weapon or an Unarmed Strike against it. The attack happens **right before** the creature leaves your reach.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. The creature **leaves your reach** (not just moves within it).
2. You **see** it.
3. It didn't use **Disengage**, nor was it teleported or forced to move.
4. You spend your **Reaction**: one melee attack.

⚠ Change from 2014

The rule is the same; the 2024 text clarifies that the attack can be an **Unarmed Strike** (so a Grapple or a Shove) and that **teleportation** and forced movement don't provoke it.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The text doesn't say how to handle invisible creatures or ambiguous reach weapons. Fix: the DM announces choices before the game.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe the enemy turning their back, leaving an opening: the blow lands before they get away.

Step 1 – Spot the trigger:

A visible creature **leaves your reach**: 5 ft by default; more with a reach weapon. Moving **within** your reach triggers nothing.

Step 2 – Check the exceptions:

No attack if the creature used **Disengage**, was **teleported**, or was **forced to move** (without using its movement, action, or Reaction).

Step 3 – Spend your Reaction:

You have only **one Reaction per round**: if already used, no Opportunity Attack. You can drop a readied action to make it.

Step 4 – Attack:

A **melee** attack with a weapon or an **Unarmed Strike** (including a Grapple or Shove). A spell doesn't qualify.

Step 5 – Resolve:

The attack roll happens **right before** the creature leaves reach. If the attack drops or kills it, it doesn't move.

Example: the goblin leaves Brann's reach without Disengage. Brann spends his Reaction: sword attack, 12 against AC 13: a miss. The goblin continues moving.

Triggers	Doesn't trigger
Leaving reach on foot	Moving within reach
Leaving reach mounted	Disengage
Leaving by crawling	Teleportation
Spending movement to leave	Forced movement
Leaving a creature that can see you	Defender can't see the creature

OPPORTUNITY ATTACK (5E, 2024 RULES) – Q&A AND DEBATE

⚠ Common questions:

How many Opportunity Attacks per round?
One: it uses your Reaction.

What reach?
5 ft, or more with a reach weapon: the trigger is leaving reach, not the square.

Does a ranged attack qualify?
No: only melee or Unarmed Strike.

Can a spell make an Opportunity Attack?
No: casting a spell is an action, not an Opportunity Attack.

Can a blinded creature make one?
No: you must see the creature leaving reach.

Can I grapple or shove?
Yes: with an Unarmed Strike attack.

Does Disengage suffice?
Yes: for the rest of the turn, no Opportunity Attacks.

Must I attack?
No: it's an option you can decline.

⚠ Debate points and table options:

Table rule

Invisible creature
If you can't see it, no attack. **Option**: the DM may allow it if you know where it is.

Ranged attack in melee
The SRD allows only melee. **Option**: also allow thrown weapons.

Circling movement
Staying within reach triggers nothing. **Option**: keep it.

Pushed creature
Forced movement doesn't provoke. **Option**: keep it.

Several defenders
Each defender has their own Reaction. **Option**: each attacks in turn.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Readied action
A readied action isn't a commitment: you can drop it for an Opportunity Attack, but you have only one Reaction per round.

Reach weapons
The attack triggers when a creature leaves reach, not the square.

Blinded
A Blinded creature can't make an Opportunity Attack, unless it has Blindsight.

Grapple or Shove
An Opportunity Attack can be a Grapple or Shove, via the Unarmed Strike.

Spell attack
A melee spell attack can't serve as an Opportunity Attack.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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